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CUET UG

History

Revolt of 1857: Patterns and Representations

Themes in Indian History Part III · Chapter 11 · Rebels and the Raj: The 1857 Revolt (c. 1857–1859 CE)

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Official Syllabus Breakdown & Exam Scope

Derived from **Themes in Indian History Part III** (Chapter 11: "Rebels and the Raj: The Revolt of 1857 and its Representations"), this unit examines the outbreak mechanisms, leadership command structures, the intense popular rebellion in Awadh, rebel mentalities and proclamations, the brutal British reconquest, and nineteenth-century visual representations of the uprising.

Sub-topic	Official syllabus pointer & key NCERT anchors	Skills the questions test
1. Mutiny Patterns & Networks	Meerut outbreak (10 May 1857); march to Delhi; proclamation of Bahadur Shah Zafar; **bell of arms** (**shastragaar**); circulation of **chapatis** and red lotuses; regimental **panchayats**.	Chronological sequence, communication channels, understanding collective rebellion mechanisms.
2. Rebel Leaders & Centers	Delhi (Zafar & Bakht Khan); Kanpur (Nana Sahib & Tatya Tope); Lucknow (Begum Hazrat Mahal & Birjis Qadr); Jhansi (Rani Lakshmibai); Bihar (Kunwar Singh); local leaders (Shah Mal, Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah, Gonoo).	Matching centers with leaders, evaluating social base of local mobilization.
3. Awadh Epicenter & Taluqdars	Lord Dalhousie's annexation (1856); Nawab Wajid Ali Shah's exile; **Summary Settlement of 1856**; dispossession of **taluqdars**; Awadh as the **"nursery of the Bengal Army"** (over 75,000 sepoys).	Policy analysis, agrarian grievance identification, evaluating popular civil rebellion.
4. Rumours & Proclamations	Enfield rifle cartridges (cow and pig grease); bone dust in flour; centenary of Battle of Plassey (23 June 1857); **Azamgarh Proclamation** (August 1857); Hindu-Muslim solidarity; ban on cow slaughter.	Primary text analysis, mentalities of revolt, religious mobilization dynamics.
5. Reconquest & Retribution	British military campaigns; John Nicholson storms Delhi; William Hodson executes Mughal princes; Colin Campbell relieves Lucknow; martial law; blowing rebels from guns; Government of India Act 1858.	Military trajectory, colonial pacification techniques, constitutional consequences.
6. Visual Representations	British colonial art: Thomas Jones Barker's **Relief of Lucknow** (1859); Joseph Noel Paton's **In Memoriam** (1859); **Punch** cartoons; nationalist memory (V.D. Savarkar, Subhadra Kumari Chauhan).	Artistic ideology analysis, comparative evaluation of colonial vs nationalist memory.

HIGH-YIELD NTA CUET DISTINCTION: MUTINY VS CIVIL REBELLION

NTA regularly tests candidates on the qualitative distinction between a military mutiny and a civil rebellion:

Military Mutiny (Sepoys breaking discipline in cantonments) → **Popular Civil Insurrection** (Taluqdars, peasants, artisans, and zamindars rising en masse)

While the uprising originated as a sepoy mutiny in Meerut and Delhi, it rapidly transformed into a deep, popular civil rebellion across Awadh, Rohilkhand, and Bihar, where civilian casualties far exceeded military casualties.

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Sub-Topic 1: Pattern of the Rebellion: Outbreak and Communications

1.1 The Spark at Meerut (10 May 1857)

The revolt began on the afternoon of **Sunday, 10 May 1857**, in the cantonment of **Meerut**:

- **Immediate Trigger**: On 9 May, 85 sepoys of the 3rd Native Cavalry were court-martialed, stripped of their uniforms in a public humiliation parade, and sentenced to ten years' hard labor for refusing to handle the newly introduced greased cartridges for the Enfield rifle.
- **The Signal**: On the afternoon of 10 May, mutiny erupted, signaled by the firing of the evening gun or a bugle call.
- **Cantonment Attack**: Sepoys broke open the military prison, freed their 85 imprisoned comrades, and stormed the **bell of arms** (**shastragaar**—the storeroom where weapons and ammunition were locked).
- **Targeting Colonial Symbols**: White British officers and civilians were shot; government offices, courts, bungalows, and post offices were torched; and telegraph wires connecting Meerut to Delhi were systematically severed.

1.2 The Midnight March to Delhi and Proclamation of the Emperor

Following the sacking of Meerut, the sepoys set out on a forced night march across the 40-mile highway to **Delhi**:

- **Arrival at the Red Fort (11 May)**: In the early morning during the sacred month of **Ramadan**, the sepoys crossed the boat bridge over the Yamuna and gathered beneath the walls of the Red Fort (**Lal Qila**).
- **Confronting the Emperor**: They demanded an audience with the aged, 82-year-old Mughal Emperor, **Bahadur Shah Zafar**. Initially reluctant to invite British retaliation, the Emperor was swept along by the armed crowd who occupied the Diwan-i-Khas.
- **Proclamation**: Bahadur Shah Zafar was formally acclaimed as **Shahenshah-i-Hindustan** (Emperor of India).
- **Legitimizing the Revolt**: This symbolic act transformed an isolated regimental mutiny into a nationwide anti-colonial war, restoring the historic authority of the Mughal dynasty as the pan-Indian sovereign center.

1.3 Communication Lines and Collective Planning

A defining feature highlighted in official records was the remarkable uniformity in the sequence of mutiny across widely separated cantonments:

- **Circulation of Chapatis**: In early 1857, reports flooded British magistrates regarding the mysterious circulation of unleavened bread (**chapatis**). A village watchman (**chaukidar**) would receive five chapatis from an adjacent village and was instructed to bake five more and dispatch them to neighboring settlements. While the precise message was never fully decoded, it created widespread psychological anticipation of imminent cosmic transformation.
- **Red Lotus Flowers**: Red lotuses were passed from hand to hand among sepoy regiments as silent pledges of fidelity.
- **Regimental Panchayats**: Sepoys held secret nightly councils (**panchayats**) in sepoy lines, debating grievances and synchronizing uprising dates across stations.

Sub-Topic 2: Leaders and Followers: Regional Command Structures

When traditional colonial authority collapsed, rebel soldiers and civilian insurgents looked to traditional aristocratic elites and charismatic local figures to assume regional leadership.

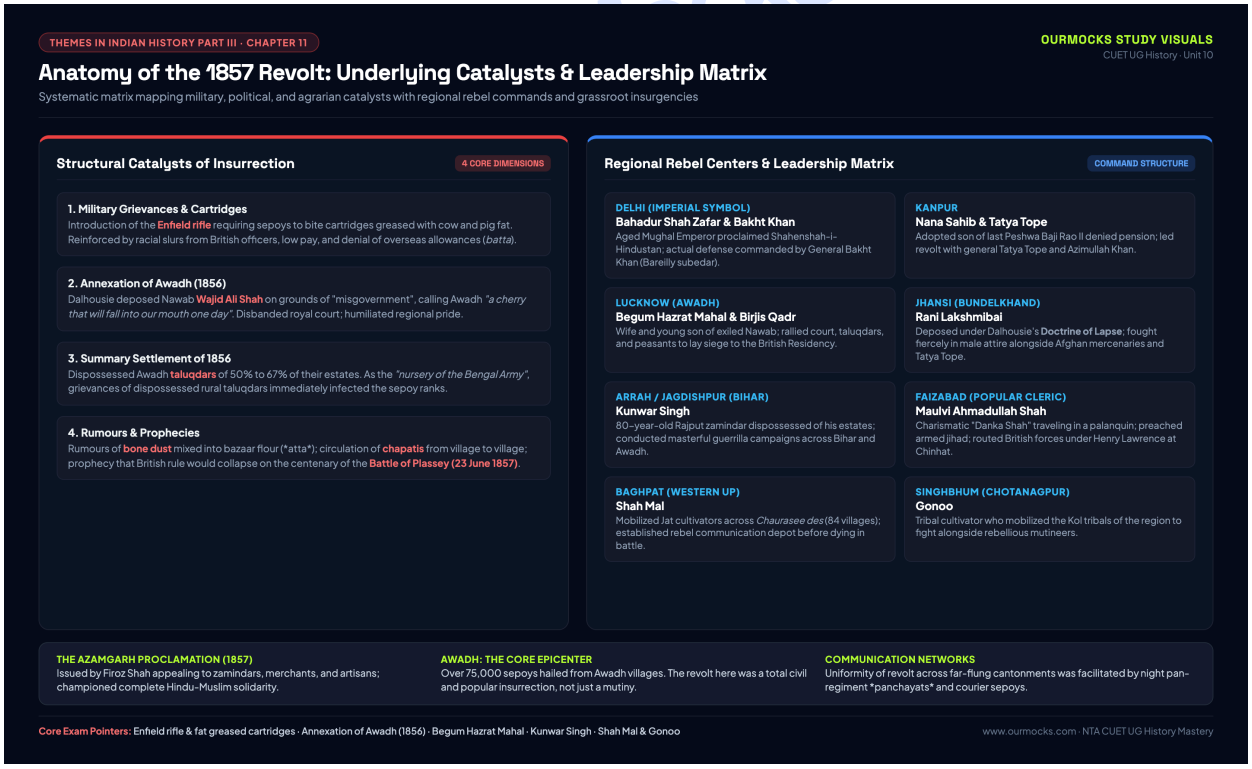


Figure 1: Systematic Matrix of 1857 Revolt Catalysts and Regional Leadership Commands

2.1 The Major Regional Centers

1. **Delhi**:

- **Bahadur Shah Zafar**: Provided sovereign legitimacy, issued imperial farmans to regional rajas, and served as the political figurehead.
- **General Bakht Khan**: A veteran subedar of artillery from the Bareilly brigade who marched his troops to Delhi, assumed practical military command of the city's defense, and instituted a ten-member administrative council (**Jalsa**).

2. **Kanpur**:
   - **Nana Sahib**: The adopted son of the last Peshwa, **Baji Rao II**. Denied his father's annual pension of £80,000 by Lord Dalhousie under the Doctrine of Lapse, Nana Sahib joined the mutinous sepoys at Kanpur, proclaimed himself Peshwa, acknowledged Bahadur Shah as Emperor, and led the siege of Hugh Wheeler's entrenchment.
   - Supported by military commander **Tatya Tope** and diplomatic adviser **Azimullah Khan**.
3. **Lucknow (Awadh)**:
   - **Begum Hazrat Mahal**: The charismatic queen of the deposed Nawab Wajid Ali Shah. In Lucknow, she crowned her eleven-year-old son, **Birjis Qadr**, as the Nawab of Awadh, organized the siege of the British Residency, and personally commanded rebel battalions on the battlefield.
4. **Jhansi**:
   - **Rani Lakshmibai**: When her husband Raja Gangadhar Rao died in 1853 without a natural male heir, Dalhousie refused to recognize their adopted son, Damodar Rao, annexing the principality under the **Doctrine of Lapse**. In June 1857, she assumed leadership of the mutinous 12th Native Infantry, donned male military attire, and defended Jhansi against British forces commanded by Sir Hugh Rose.
5. **Arrah / Jagdishpur (Bihar)**:
   - **Kunwar Singh**: An 80-year-old Rajput zamindar of Jagdishpur near Arrah. Bankrupted and dispossessed of his vast ancestral estates by the Board of Revenue, Kunwar Singh joined the rebellious Danapur sepoys, displaying brilliant guerrilla mobility across Bihar and eastern Uttar Pradesh until his death from battle wounds in April 1858.

2.2 Local and Popular Leaders

Beyond royal courts, ordinary individuals emerged as powerful grassroots leaders:

- **Shah Mal**: A local resident of village Bijrol in **Baghpat** (western Uttar Pradesh). He mobilized the headmen and cultivators of **Chaurasee des** (eighty-four Jat villages), tore down telegraph poles, destroyed bridges over the Yamuna, and turned a government bungalow into a rebel intelligence hub until he was slain in combat in July 1857.
- **Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah**: Known affectionately as **Danka Shah** (the Maulvi with the drum). Traveling across northern India in a palanquin with drums beating ahead, he prophesied the imminent collapse of the English. In Awadh, he led a massive force that defeated the British under Sir Henry Lawrence at the celebrated **Battle of Chinhat** (June 1857).
- **Gonoo**: A poor Kol tribal cultivator who organized tribal communities across the **Singhbhum** region of Chotanagpur to fight alongside rebellious mutineers.

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Sub-Topic 3: Awadh in Revolt: Annexation, Taluqdars & Sepoy Nursery

3.1 "A Cherry That Will Fall Into Our Mouth One Day"

No region witnessed more fierce, universal resistance than the kingdom of **Awadh**:

- **Gradual Subjugation**: In **1801**, Lord Wellesley imposed the **Subsidiary Alliance** on Awadh, disbanding the Nawab's military forces, stationing a British Resident at Lucknow, and annexing over half of the kingdom's territory (including Rohilkhand and the Lower Doab).
- **Dalhousie's Prediction**: In **1851**, Governor-General **Lord Dalhousie** famously described the kingdom of Awadh as **"a cherry that will fall into our mouth one day"**.
- **The Annexation (1856)**: In **February 1856**, Awadh was formally annexed to the British Empire on the pretext of "chronic misgovernment" (**maladministration**). The reigning Nawab, **Wajid Ali Shah**, was dethroned and exiled to Metiabruz near Calcutta.
- **Popular Mourning**: The annexation produced immense collective sorrow across Lucknow. Contemporary Urdu chronicles recorded: **"The life was gone out of the body, and the body of this town had been left lifeless... there was no street or market and house which did not wail out the cry of agony in separation of Jan-i-Alam (the Nawab)."**

3.2 The Summary Settlement of 1856 and Taluqdar Dispossession

Immediately following annexation, the British introduced the **Summary Settlement of 1856**:

- **Ideological Rationale**: British revenue officials operated on the mistaken assumption that the landed gentry of Awadh—the **taluqdars**—were illegitimate extortionists who had acquired land through force.
- **Dispossession**: The settlement aimed to bypass taluqdars and settle revenues directly with cultivators. Consequently, taluqdars were stripped of their ancestral estates; some lost more than **half to two-thirds** of all their villages.
- **Demolition of Forts**: The British dismantled the private mud-and-stone forts (**qilachas**) of the taluqdars and confiscated their cannon and armed retainers.
- **Peasant Solidarity**: Rather than celebrating liberation from taluqdars, the peasants of Awadh rallied around their traditional landed lords. Taluqdars maintained patron-client ties of customary support; during famine, taluqdars had offered loans, whereas colonial revenue demands were inflexible and unyielding.

3.3 The "Nursery of the Bengal Army"

Awadh was universally renowned as the **"nursery of the Bengal Army"**:

- Over **75,000 sepoys** serving in the East India Company's Bengal Army were recruited from Awadh and eastern Uttar Pradesh.
- Almost every peasant household in Awadh had a son, brother, or father in the sepoy ranks.
- Consequently, sepoy grievances regarding pay, dismissive British officers, and the greased cartridges directly resonated in Awadh villages, while the humiliation of the Nawab's

annexation incensed the sepoys in their distant barracks. The sepoy was, in essence, **"a peasant in uniform"**.

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Sub-Topic 4: Rumours, Prophecies, and the Azamgarh Proclamation

4.1 The Psychology of Rumours

Rumours and prophecies played a powerful role in firing popular imagination:

- **The Greased Cartridges**: The new **Enfield P-53 rifle** used pre-greased paper cartridges whose tips had to be bitten off with teeth before powder could be poured into the barrel. In January 1857, a low-caste khalasi at Dum Dum arsenal taunted a high-caste sepoy that the grease was manufactured from the fat of **cows** (sacred to Hindus) and **pigs** (forbidden to Muslims). The rumor spread like wildfire.
- **Bone Dust in Flour**: Rumours claimed the British had pulverized the bones of cows and oxen and mixed the dust into flour (**atta**) sold in bazaar markets to forcibly destroy caste purity and convert the populace to Christianity.
- **Plassey Centenary**: Astrologers and wandering fakirs prophesied that British dominion in India was destined to perish precisely **one hundred years** after the **Battle of Plassey (23 June 1757)**.

WHY DID PEOPLE BELIEVE THE RUMOURS?

Colonial officials dismissed these rumours as irrational superstition. However, NCERT emphasizes that rumours were believed because they resonated with existing anxieties:

- Under Lord William Bentinck and Lord Dalhousie, the British introduced radical Western social reforms (Abolition of Sati 1829, Widow Remarriage Act 1856, English education).
- Christian missionaries were actively patronized by colonial officials and proselytized in military hospitals, orphanages, and prisons.
- The **Religious Disabilities Act (Lex Loci) of 1850** permitted converts to Christianity to inherit ancestral Hindu property. To traditional Indian society, these policies appeared as a coordinated conspiracy to obliterate indigenous faith (**dharma** and **deen**).

4.2 Proclamations of Unity: The Azamgarh Proclamation (1857)

Rebel leaders issued numerous manifestos appealing to all sections of Indian society. The most prominent was the **Azamgarh Proclamation**, issued on **25 August 1857** under the name of Firoz Shah, a grandson of the Mughal Emperor:

- **Appeals to Multiple Classes**:
  - **To Zamindars**: Promised absolute security of their hereditary estates and the abolition of extortionate colonial revenue settlements.

- **To Merchants**: Guaranteed free internal trade, protection from arbitrary colonial transit duties, and state subsidies for riverine transport.
- **To Public Servants**: Promised dignity, high military commands, and senior administrative salaries, ending racial exclusion.
- **To Artisans**: Promised state patronage for indigenous handloom textiles and handicrafts, which had been crippled by cheap Manchester manufactured imports.

- **Hindu-Muslim Solidarity**: All proclamations addressed both Hindus and Muslims equally. Rebel governments enforced strict bans on the slaughter of cows to respect Hindu religious sentiments. The British attempted to foster communal riots (e.g., spending £50,000 in Bareilly to incite Hindus against Muslims), but the strategy failed completely.

Sub-Topic 5: British Reconquest, Counter-Terror, and Trajectory

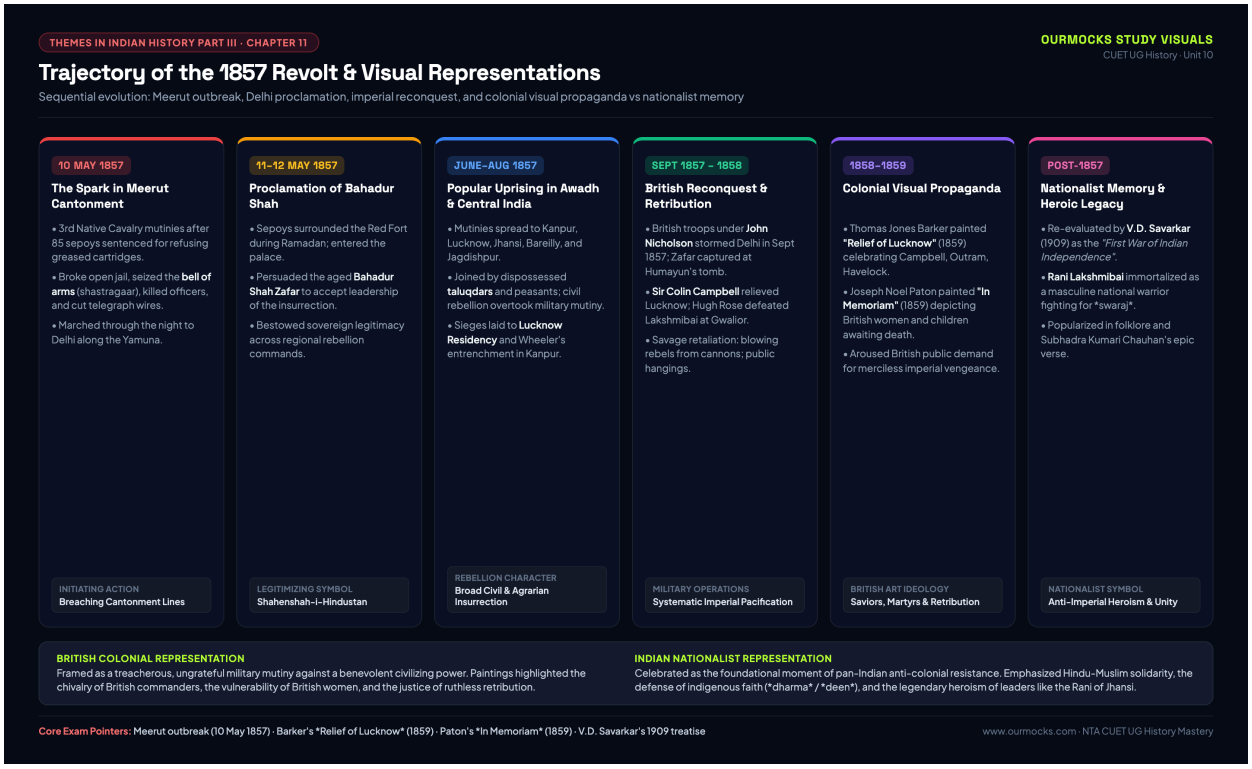


Figure 2: Chronological Trajectory of the 1857 Revolt and Representations

5.1 Military Reconquest

The British mobilized their full imperial military might to crush the insurrection:

- **Recapture of Delhi (Sept 1857)**: British forces under Brigadier-General **John Nicholson** breached the walls of Delhi at Kashmiri Gate after heavy fighting. Nicholson was mortally wounded, but Delhi fell on **20 September 1857**.
- **Capture of Bahadur Shah Zafar**: Captain **William Hodson** captured the Emperor at **Humayun's tomb**. Hodson personally shot dead two of Zafar's sons (Mirza Mughal and Mirza Khizr Sultan) and his grandson at point-blank range near the Delhi Gate (known thereafter as **Khooni Darwaza**). Zafar was tried for treason and exiled to **Rangoon**, where he died in 1862.

- **Relief and Recapture of Lucknow**: Sir Colin Campbell broke through the rebel encirclement of the Lucknow Residency in March 1858, using heavy artillery and Gurkha regiments commanded by Jung Bahadur.
- **Central India Campaigns**: Sir Hugh Rose defeated Rani Lakshmibai at Jhansi, Kalpi, and finally at **Kotah-ki-Sarai** near Gwalior on **18 June 1858**, where the Rani fell in battle.

5.2 Imperial Retribution and Counter-Terror

The British enacted draconian martial law acts in May and June 1857:

- Military officers and ordinary British civilians were granted summary powers to try, convict, and hang any Indian suspected of rebellion without judicial appeals.
- Thousands of rebels were executed by being tied to the muzzles of cannons and blown apart (**blowing from guns**). Villages throughout the Doab and Awadh were torched, and hanging corpses lined the Grand Trunk Road.

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Sub-Topic 6: Images and Representations of the Revolt

NCERT places special historiographical emphasis on how the 1857 revolt was recorded, visually depicted, and mythologized by both the British and Indian nationalists.

6.1 British Colonial Art: Saviors, Martyrs, and Retribution

British artists and journalists produced visual representations designed to reinforce imperial prestige, evoke patriotic pity, and justify ruthless retribution:

- **Thomas Jones Barker — "Relief of Lucknow" (1859)**:
  - Depicts the dramatic moment when Sir Colin Campbell, Sir James Outram, and Sir Henry Havelock met at the battered Lucknow Residency.
  - The British commanders occupy the heroic, sunlit foreground on noble horses, while wounded soldiers on stretchers symbolize British sacrifice and resilience.
  - Celebrates the victory of British military order over chaos.
- **Joseph Noel Paton — "In Memoriam" (1859)**:
  - Depicts defenseless British women and children huddled together in prayer in a dim, ruined cellar, expecting imminent assault by unseen rebel sepoys.
  - Designed to incite rage and evoke protective instincts in the Victorian British public, portraying the mutineers as savage monsters and justifying the slaughter of Indian civilians.
  - (Notably, when news arrived that British troops had reconquered Lucknow, Paton repainted the background, substituting the approaching rebel soldiers with rescuing British Highlanders).
- **Satirical Propaganda in "Punch"**:
  - The British satirical magazine **Punch** printed cartoons such as **"Justice"** (depicting a colossal British female allegorical figure trampling mutineers beneath her feet, brandishing a flaming sword and shield) and **"The British Lion's Vengeance on the Bengal Tiger"**.

6.2 Indian Nationalist Memory and Heroic Myth

In the early twentieth century, Indian nationalists reclaimed the 1857 revolt from colonial historiography:

- **V.D. Savarkar**: Published **The Indian War of Independence 1857** in **1909**, rejecting the colonial label of a "sepoy mutiny" and celebrating the uprising as India's first unified national struggle for **Swaraj**.
- **Rani Lakshmibai as Nationalist Icon**:
  - The Rani of Jhansi was transformed into the supreme national icon of anti-imperialist courage.
  - Celebrated in popular folk theater and literature, most famously in the Hindi ballad composed by **Subhadra Kumari Chauhan**:

    "Khoob ladi mardani woh to Jhansi wali rani thi"
    (Bravely fought the masculine warrior, she was the Queen of Jhansi)
  - Depicted in popular calendar prints riding a charging white stallion, holding the reins between her teeth, brandishing a curved sword, and carrying her adopted infant son strapped to her back.

Sub-Topic 7: Comprehensive Chapter Synthesizer Mindmap

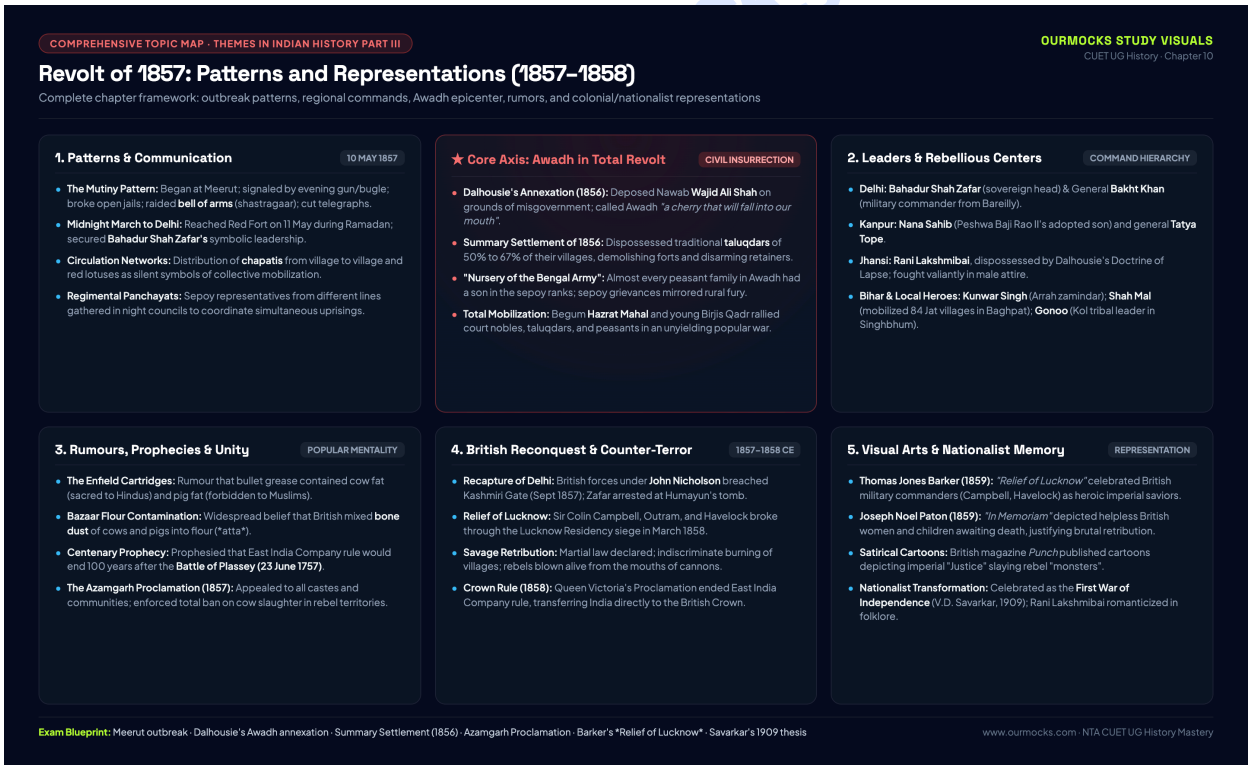


Figure 3: Comprehensive Synthesizer Mindmap: Revolt of 1857 Patterns, Trajectory, and Representations

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High-Yield Chronology & Nomenclature Reference

Year / Date	Historical Milestone & Rebel Development
1801 CE	Lord Wellesley imposes the Subsidiary Alliance on Nawab Saadat Ali Khan of Awadh.
1851 CE	Lord Dalhousie characterizes Awadh as "a cherry that will fall into our mouth one day".
1856 CE (Feb)	Awadh annexed to the British Empire on grounds of misgovernment; Wajid Ali Shah exiled.
1856 CE	British introduce the **Summary Settlement of 1856**, stripping Awadh taluqdars of their estates.
1857 CE (29 March)	**Mangal Pandey** of the 34th Native Infantry mutinies at Barrackpore; attacks officers.
1857 CE (10 May)	Outbreak of the Revolt at Meerut cantonment; sepoys sack armory and march to Delhi.
1857 CE (11 May)	Rebel sepoys enter Red Fort; proclaim Bahadur Shah Zafar **Shahenshah-i-Hindustan**.
1857 CE (25 Aug)	Promulgation of the **Azamgarh Proclamation** championing communal unity and rebel aims.
1857 CE (20 Sept)	British troops under John Nicholson recapture Delhi; Zafar captured at Humayun's tomb.
1858 CE (March)	Sir Colin Campbell, Havelock, and Outram recapture Lucknow from Begum Hazrat Mahal.
1858 CE (18 June)	Rani Lakshmibai martyred in battle at Kotah-ki-Sarai near Gwalior fighting Sir Hugh Rose.
1858 CE (1 Nov)	Queen Victoria's Proclamation transfers governance from East India Company to the British Crown.
1859 CE	Thomas Jones Barker paints **Relief of Lucknow**; Joseph Noel Paton exhibits **In Memoriam**.

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High-Yield NTA CUET Practice Questions (15 MCQs)

Q1. The Revolt of 1857 broke out on 10 May 1857 in which military cantonment?

(A) Barrackpore
(B) Meerut
(C) Delhi
(D) Ambala

Sol. Q1. The Revolt commenced on 10 May 1857 in the cantonment of Meerut when the 3rd Native Cavalry mutinied, broke open the jail, and marched to Delhi.

Answer: (B)

Q2. Which Governor-General famously characterized the kingdom of Awadh in 1851 as "a cherry that will fall into our mouth one day"?

(A) Lord Wellesley
(B) Lord William Bentinck
(C) Lord Dalhousie
(D) Lord Canning

Sol. Q2. Lord Dalhousie described Awadh in 1851 as "a cherry that will fall into our mouth one day", ultimately annexing it in February 1856 on the pretext of misgovernment.

Answer: (C)

Q3. The storeroom where weapons and ammunition were locked in British cantonments, targeted by sepoys at the start of mutinies, was termed:

(A) Kachari
(B) Bell of arms (shastragaar)
(C) Karkhana
(D) Kotwali

Sol. Q3. The weapon storeroom was called the **bell of arms** (**shastragaar**). In almost every cantonment, sepoys began their uprising by storming this armory.

Answer: (B)

Q4. Who led the armed uprising in Lucknow, crowning her minor son Birjis Qadr as Nawab?

(A) Rani Lakshmibai
(B) Begum Hazrat Mahal
(C) Zeenat Mahal
(D) Jhalkaribai

Sol. Q4. Begum Hazrat Mahal, queen of the exiled Nawab Wajid Ali Shah, led the uprising in Lucknow, crowning her eleven-year-old son Birjis Qadr.

Answer: (B)

Q5. The elderly Rajput zamindar of Jagdishpur who led the revolt across western Bihar was:

(A) Kunwar Singh
(B) Amar Singh
(C) Shah Mal
(D) Gonoo

Sol. Q5. Kunwar Singh, an 80-year-old Rajput zamindar of Jagdishpur near Arrah, led the rebel sepoys and conducted guerrilla campaigns across Bihar.

Answer: (A)

Q6. In western Uttar Pradesh (Baghpat), which local leader mobilized the villagers of **Chaurasee des** (84 Jat villages) against the British?

(A) Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah **(B)** Shah Mal
(C) Bakht Khan **(D)** Tatya Tope

Sol. Q6. Shah Mal mobilized the headmen and cultivators of **Chaurasee des** (eighty-four Jat villages) in Baghpat, organizing rebel logistics until he fell in battle in July 1857.

Answer: (B)

Q7. The British revenue measure implemented immediately after the annexation of Awadh that dispossessed traditional taluqdars of their estates was called:

(A) The Permanent Settlement of 1856 **(B)** The Summary Settlement of 1856
(C) The Ryotwari Settlement of 1856 **(D)** The Mahalwari Settlement of 1856

Sol. Q7. The **Summary Settlement of 1856** removed Awadh taluqdars from over 50% to 67% of their villages on the assumption that they were illegitimate extortionists.

Answer: (B)

Q8. Which famous proclamation was issued on 25 August 1857 under the name of Firoz Shah, appealing to all classes and emphasizing Hindu-Muslim unity?

(A) The Delhi Proclamation **(B)** The Azamgarh Proclamation
(C) The Lucknow Declaration **(D)** The Meerut Manifesto

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Sol. Q8. The **Azamgarh Proclamation** (25 August 1857) called upon all sections of Indian society (zamindars, merchants, public servants, artisans) to unite against British rule.

Answer: (B)

Q9. The charismatic cleric from Faizabad known as "Danka Shah" who defeated Sir Henry Lawrence at the Battle of Chinhat was:

(A) Maulvi Liaquat Ali **(B)** Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah
(C) General Bakht Khan **(D)** Fazl-e-Haq Khairabadi

Sol. Q9. Maulvi Ahmadullah Shah (Danka Shah) was a popular preacher who traveled in a palanquin with drums, routing British troops at Chinhat in June 1857.

Answer: (B)

Q10. Which celebrated British painting by Thomas Jones Barker (1859) glorified Sir Colin Campbell, Outram, and Havelock as imperial saviors?

(A) In Memoriam **(B)** Relief of Lucknow
(C) The Capture of Bahadur Shah **(D)** The Execution of Mutineers

Sol. Q10. Thomas Jones Barker painted **Relief of Lucknow** (1859) celebrating the meeting of Campbell, Outram, and Havelock upon relieving the besieged Residency.

Answer: (B)

Q11. Joseph Noel Paton's painting **In Memoriam** (1859) aroused intense public outrage in Victorian Britain by depicting:

(A) British cavalry slaughtering rebel sepoys
(B) Helpless British women and children huddled in prayer awaiting death
(C) The hanging of Mangal Pandey at Barrackpore
(D) The coronation of Bahadur Shah Zafar at the Red Fort

Sol. Q11. In Memoriam depicted British women and children huddled in prayer in a ruined cellar, expecting imminent death, stirring public demand for brutal retribution.

Answer: (B)

Q12. Who authored the influential nationalist book **The Indian War of Independence 1857** in 1909?

(A) Bal Gangadhar Tilak
(B) V.D. Savarkar
(C) Bipin Chandra Pal
(D) Lala Lajpat Rai

Sol. Q12. Vinayak Damodar Savarkar authored **The Indian War of Independence 1857** in 1909, interpreting the revolt as a unified national war for freedom.

Answer: (B)

Q13. The Kol tribal leader from Singhbhum (Chotanagpur) who led his people alongside the mutineers in 1857 was:

(A) Birsa Munda
(B) Sidhu Murmu
(C) Gonoo
(D) Kanhu Murmu

Sol. Q13. Gonoo, an ordinary Kol tribal cultivator of Singhbhum, mobilized tribal fighters to battle British forces during the 1857 insurrection.

Answer: (C)

Q14. Which British officer captured Bahadur Shah Zafar at Humayun's tomb and shot his sons at point-blank range near Khooni Darwaza?

(A) John Nicholson
(B) William Hodson
(C) Hugh Rose
(D) Colin Campbell

Sol. Q14. Captain William Hodson captured Bahadur Shah Zafar at Humayun's tomb and summarily executed the royal princes at Delhi Gate.

Answer: (B)

Q15. Which of the following lines from Subhadra Kumari Chauhan's poem immortalized the memory of Rani Lakshmibai in nationalist consciousness?

(A) Sarfaroshi ki tamanna ab hamare dil mein hai
(B) Khoob ladi mardani woh to Jhansi wali rani thi
(C) Vande Mataram, sujalaam sufalaam
(D) Inquilab Zindabad

Sol. Q15. Subhadra Kumari Chauhan's famous ballad celebrates the Rani of Jhansi with the refrain: **"Khoob ladi mardani woh to Jhansi wali rani thi"** (Bravely fought the masculine warrior, she was the Queen of Jhansi).

Answer: (B)

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Wrong-Answer Clinic (CUET Traps & Common Misconceptions)

Common Mistake / Confusion	NTA Examination Trap	Correct Historical Fact & NCERT Clarification
Confusing Outbreak Dates	Assuming the revolt began on 29 March with Mangal Pandey.	Mangal Pandey's isolated protest occurred on 29 March at Barrackpore. The actual nationwide **Revolt of 1857** officially broke out on **10 May 1857** at **Meerut**.
Assuming Awadh Taluqdars hated their Peasants	Believing peasants welcomed the British Summary Settlement.	Peasants maintained traditional ties of loyalty to their taluqdars. When taluqdars rose against the British, their peasant tenants joined them en masse.
Misinterpreting the Azamgarh Proclamation	Assuming it was issued by Bahadur Shah Zafar.	The proclamation was issued on 25 August 1857 under the name of **Firoz Shah**, a royal prince and relative of the Emperor.
Confusing Barker's and Paton's Paintings	Matching Paton with the Relief of Lucknow and Barker with In Memoriam.	**Thomas Jones Barker** painted **Relief of Lucknow** (celebrating commanders). **Joseph Noel Paton** painted **In Memoriam** (depicting women and children).
Believing the Revolt was purely communal	Asserting that Hindus and Muslims fought against each other in 1857.	The 1857 revolt was distinguished by remarkable Hindu-Muslim solidarity. Proclamations addressed both communities, and rebel regimes banned cow slaughter.